

Day 99 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Polity (8): CIC's 2026 Ruling on BCCI and the RTI Act

READING MATERIAL

Covers a notable 2026 Central Information Commission (CIC) ruling and reinforces the CIC's structure under the RTI Act, 2005.

Q: What did the Central Information Commission (CIC) rule on 18 May 2026, regarding the BCCI?

A: That the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) is NOT covered by the Right to Information Act, 2005 — meaning BCCI cannot be compelled to disclose information under RTI requests.

Q: What reasoning did the CIC give for this ruling?

A: It warned that imposing government-style RTI control over BCCI could risk disrupting what it called a 'finely balanced economic structure'.

Q: What is the Central Information Commission (CIC), and under which Act was it established?

A: An independent body established under the Right to Information Act, 2005, to promote transparency and accountability in public authorities — comprising a Chief Information Commissioner and up to 10 Information Commissioners.

Q: What change did the 2019 RTI Amendment make to the CIC's structure?

A: It reduced Information Commissioners' tenure to 3 years and made their salary/terms of service determined by the government (previously fixed by statute), rather than being independently set.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. On 18 May 2026, the Central Information Commission ruled that which body is NOT covered by the RTI Act, 2005?

- A. ISRO
- B. BCCI ✓**
- C. RBI
- D. SEBI

Explanation: BCCI (Board of Control for Cricket in India). [medium, web-research]

2. The CIC was established under which Act?

- A. The Lokpal Act, 2013
- B. The Right to Information Act, 2005 ✓**
- C. The Whistleblowers Protection Act, 2014
- D. The Companies Act, 2013

Explanation: The Right to Information Act, 2005. [easy, web-research]

3. The CIC comprises a Chief Information Commissioner and up to how many Information Commissioners?

- A. 5
- B. 8
- C. 10 ✓**
- D. 12

Explanation: 10. [medium, web-research]

4. The 2019 RTI Amendment changed Information Commissioners' tenure to:

- A. 2 years
- B. 3 years ✓**
- C. 5 years
- D. 6 years

Explanation: 3 years. [hard, web-research]

5. Per the 2019 RTI Amendment, who determines Information Commissioners' salary and terms of service?

- A. The Supreme Court

B. The Election Commission

C. The Government ✓

D. The Parliament's Standing Committee

Explanation: The Government. [hard, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Highest Common Factor (HCF)

READING MATERIAL

HCF is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence (4 confirmed hits across 2022/2024/2025) shows TNPSC favors HCF *application* problems — measuring/tiling/container word problems and the HCF-LCM relationship — over plain 'find the HCF of these two numbers' questions, so the reading below leads with those application shapes.

Q: Real exam (2025): Two numbers are in the ratio 15:11. If their HCF is 13, find the numbers.

A: When two numbers are in a given ratio, write them as $15k$ and $11k$. Since $\text{HCF}(15,11)=1$ (the ratio is already in lowest terms), k IS the HCF — so $k=13$. The numbers are $15 \times 13=195$ and $11 \times 13=143$.

Q: Real exam (2025): What is the least number of square tiles needed to pave the ceiling of a room 15m 17cm long and 9m 2cm broad?

A: Convert to one unit: $1517 \text{ cm} \times 902 \text{ cm}$. The LARGEST square tile that exactly fits (no cutting) has a side equal to the HCF of the two dimensions. $\text{HCF}(1517, 902) = 41 \text{ cm}$ (via the Euclidean algorithm: $1517=1 \times 902+615$; $902=1 \times 615+287$; $615=2 \times 287+41$; $287=7 \times 41+0$). Tile area = $41 \times 41 = 1,681 \text{ cm}^2$. Room area = $1517 \times 902 = 1,368,334 \text{ cm}^2$. Number of tiles = $1,368,334 \div 1,681 = 814$.

Q: Real exam (2024): If the HCF of x^3-8y^3 and $x^2-k^2y^2$ is $x+ky$, find k .

A: Factor x^3-8y^3 using $a^3-b^3=(a-b)(a^2+ab+b^2)$ with $a=x$, $b=2y$: $x^3-8y^3 = (x-2y)(x^2+2xy+4y^2)$. Factor $x^2-k^2y^2$ using $a^2-b^2=(a-b)(a+b)$: $x^2-k^2y^2 = (x-ky)(x+ky)$. For ' $x+ky$ ' to be the common factor (HCF) of both, it must match one of the first expression's factors. $(x-2y)$ is the only linear factor available there, so $x+ky$ must equal $x-2y$, giving $k=-2$.

Q: Real exam (2022): What is the greatest possible volume of a vessel that can exactly measure the milk in cans of 80, 100, and 120 litres (each can measured to full capacity only)?

A: This is asking for the HCF of 80, 100, and 120. $\text{HCF}(80,100)=20$, then $\text{HCF}(20,120)=20$. So the answer is 20 litres — the largest vessel that can measure each can's full volume an exact whole number of times.

Q: Real exam (2022): The HCF and LCM of two numbers are 16 and 240 respectively. If one number is 48, find the other.

A: Use the relationship: $\text{HCF} \times \text{LCM} = \text{product of the two numbers}$. $16 \times 240 = 3,840$. Other number = $3,840 \div 48 = 80$.

Q: Method — finding HCF via the Euclidean algorithm (the fast way for large numbers): What is the HCF of 1517 and 902?

A: Repeatedly divide the larger by the smaller and replace the larger with the remainder, until the remainder is 0 — the last nonzero remainder is the HCF. $1517=1 \times 902+615 \rightarrow 902=1 \times 615+287 \rightarrow 615=2 \times 287+41 \rightarrow 287=7 \times 41+0$. $\text{HCF}=41$. This is the same calculation used in ro2 above — recognize it as the standard fast method rather than listing all factors of both numbers.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Two numbers are in the ratio 21:14. If their HCF is 12, find the larger number.

A. 36 ✓

B. 24

C. 252

D. 168

Explanation: Watch out: 21 and 14 are NOT coprime ($\text{gcd}=7$), so you can't directly multiply them by the HCF. Reduce the ratio first: $21:14 = 3:2$ (coprime). Now apply the HCF: larger = $3 \times 12=36$, smaller = $2 \times 12=24$. [hard, authored]

2. Find the largest square tile that can exactly pave a floor measuring 3m 8cm by 4m 20cm (no cutting).

A. 28 cm ✓

B. 14 cm

C. 56 cm

D. 84 cm

Explanation: Convert to cm: 308 and 420. $\text{HCF}(308,420)$: $420=1 \times 308+112$; $308=2 \times 112+84$; $112=1 \times 84+28$; $84=3 \times 28+0$. $\text{HCF}=28 \text{ cm}$. [hard, authored]

3. If the HCF of a^2-4b^2 and $a^2+ab-6b^2$ is $a-2b$, this is consistent with which factorization of the second expression?

A. $(a+3b)(a-2b)$ ✓

B. $(a-3b)(a+2b)$

C. $(a+3b)(a+2b)$

D. $(a-3b)(a-2b)$

Explanation: $a^2-4b^2=(a-2b)(a+2b)$. The second expression factors as $(a+3b)(a-2b) = a^2+ab-6b^2$ — sharing the common factor $(a-2b)$, so that's the HCF. [hard, authored]

4. What is the greatest volume that can exactly measure the contents of drums holding 72, 96, and 120 litres?

A. 12 litres

B. 24 litres ✓

C. 8 litres

D. 6 litres

Explanation: $\text{HCF}(72, 96) = 24$, then $\text{HCF}(24, 120) = 24$. Answer: 24 litres. [medium, authored]

5. The HCF and LCM of two numbers are 12 and 180 respectively. If one number is 36, find the other.

A. 48

B. 54

C. 60 ✓

D. 72

Explanation: $\text{HCF} \times \text{LCM} = 12 \times 180 = 2,160$. Other number = $2,160 \div 36 = 60$. [medium, authored]

6. Using the Euclidean algorithm, find the HCF of 1,073 and 925.

A. 37 ✓

B. 29

C. 31

D. 43

Explanation: $1073 = 1 \times 925 + 148$; $925 = 6 \times 148 + 37$; $148 = 4 \times 37 + 0$. $\text{HCF} = 37$. [medium, authored]

7. Two numbers are in the ratio 8:9 and their HCF is 7. Find their sum.

A. 105

B. 119 ✓

C. 126

D. 112

Explanation: Numbers: $8 \times 7 = 56$ and $9 \times 7 = 63$. Sum = $56 + 63 = 119$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "Advice from a Tree" — Ilan Shamir

READING MATERIAL

A poem using a tree's life as an extended metaphor for life advice — each tree-related image (roots, limbs, seasons, leaves) maps to a piece of wisdom. Unlike most other poems in this syllabus, real exam evidence here favours idiom/phrase MEANING questions over figure-of-speech labelling — know what each phrase means, not just what device it is.

Q: Who wrote "Advice from a Tree", and what's notable about him?

A: Ilan Shamir — notable for having planted over 50,000 trees and led more than 800 tree-planting celebrations worldwide, directly living out the nature-connection theme of his own poem. (He also wrote "The River", elsewhere in this same syllabus.)

Q: What is the poem's central theme?

A: Nature as a guide for living — using a tree's life and growth as a metaphor for how to live well.

Q: What does "Stand tall and proud" mean in the poem?

A: Have confidence and self-respect — not arrogance or literal height, but quiet inner confidence.

Q: What does "Sink your roots deeply into the Earth" mean?

A: Stay grounded and stable — having a firm foundation/values to rely on, just as a tree's roots anchor and stabilize it.

Q: What does "Go out on a limb" mean?

A: Take a risk — a common English idiom (literally, climbing onto a tree branch that might not hold your weight) used here for stepping beyond your comfort zone.

Q: What do the poem's seasons represent, and what does "the wisdom to let go of leaves in the Fall" symbolize?

A: The seasons represent stages and lessons of life. Letting go of leaves in Fall symbolizes letting go of burdens or attachments — knowing when to release what no longer serves you, just as a tree sheds leaves before winter.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "Advice from a Tree" was written by:

- A. Henry Van Dyke
- B. Ilan Shamir ✓**
- C. William Henry Davies
- D. Robert Frost

Explanation: Ilan Shamir. [easy, web-research]

2. The central theme of the poem is:

- A. Urban life
- B. Nature as a guide for living ✓**
- C. Space exploration
- D. Mythical creatures

Explanation: Nature as a guide for living. [easy, web-research]

3. In the poem, "Stand tall and proud" means:

- A. Show off your wealth
- B. Be arrogant
- C. Have confidence and self-respect ✓**
- D. Be physically taller than others

Explanation: Confidence and self-respect. [medium, web-research]

4. "Sink your roots deeply into the Earth" means:

- A. Dig a hole
- B. Stay grounded and stable ✓**
- C. Run away
- D. Become a farmer

Explanation: Stay grounded and stable. [medium, web-research]

5. "Go out on a limb" means:

A. Sit on a tree branch literally

B. Take a risk ✓

C. Cut a tree

D. Be lazy

Explanation: Take a risk — a common idiom. [medium, web-research]

6. "The wisdom to let go of leaves in the Fall" symbolizes:

A. Changing clothes for the season

B. Letting go of burdens or attachments ✓

C. Cutting down trees

D. Buying seasonal gifts

Explanation: Letting go of burdens or attachments. [medium, web-research]